

MODERN INDIAN HISTORY



LEFTISTS MOVEMENT

LEFTIST MOVEMENT

INTRODUCTION



- 1** Left is generally considered to be synonymous with socialism, because socialism is an ideology which aims at the uplifting of the toiling workers and protecting them from exploitation by the capitalists.
- 2** The word “Left” used in represents ideology that favors radical reforms in the Government and in the socio-economic order so that the unprivileged and oppressed sections of the society could benefit from the same.

COMMUNIST IDEOLOGY: THE RISE AND GROWTH OF THE LEFT IN INDIA

COMMUNIST PARTY IN INDIA

- 1** **Russian Revolution (1917)** influenced a large number of radical elements around the world.



- 2** In India, **Marxist ideology** came to be **accepted** by some revolutionary nationalists.
- 3** The earliest to be influenced by Marxism was **Manabendra Nath Roy**.
- 4** He attended the second Comintern Congress in 1920 as a delegate and **formed the Communist Party of India in Tashkent in 1920.**

COMMUNIST IDEOLOGY: THE RISE AND GROWTH OF THE LEFT IN INDIA

COMMUNIST PARTY IN INDIA



MANABENDRA
NATH ROY



VIRENDRA NATH
CHATTOPADHYAYA

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Meanwhile, the revolutionaries like **Virendra Nath Chattopadhyaya, Bhupendra Nath Dutt and Barkatullah** who were working outside India embraced Marxism.



BARKATULLAH



BHUPENDRA
NATH DUTT

COMMUNIST IDEOLOGY: THE RISE AND GROWTH OF THE LEFT IN INDIA

1920

Communist Party of India was formed Tashkent

1922

Suspension of NCM

Some Indians especially youth turned to Communism

1923

PESHAWAR CONSPIRACY CASE

Muslims were going to Moscow from Peshawar for getting trained relating to Military and Communist regimes.

When they returned to create disturbances they were arrested and sentenced to long imprisonment.

COMMUNIST IDEOLOGY: THE RISE AND GROWTH OF THE LEFT IN INDIA

1924

KANPUR – BOLSHEVIK CONSPIRACY



S A DANGE

Newly turned communists Muzaffar Ahamed, S A Dange, Shaukat Usmani, Nalini Gupta, Singaravelu Chettiar, Ghulam Hussain were **caught for conspiring against government**

The case was much hyped in newspapers and introduced communism to Indian public

Ghulam Hussain turned a British informer and was pardoned.

MN Roy was charged in absentia, so he was not arrested.



GHULAM HUSSAIN



SINGARAVELU CHETTIAR



MUZAFFAR AHAMED



M.N. ROY



MUZAFFAR AHAMED

COMMUNIST IDEOLOGY: THE RISE AND GROWTH OF THE LEFT IN INDIA

1925

All India Conference of Communist Party - Kanpur



SINGARAVELU CHETTIAR

Under **Presidency of Singaravelu Chettiar**

Kanpur Conference is regarded as formal beginning of Communist Party of India

Aimed at

- Attainment of complete independence
- Reorganization of Indian society on basis of common ownership
- Control of means of production
- Distribution of wealth in the interest of all

COMMUNIST IDEOLOGY: THE RISE AND GROWTH OF THE LEFT IN INDIA

1925 onwards



A COMMUNIST ACTIVIST

British communist started coming to India for organizing the **Indian Communist Movement**

Philip Spratt – infused fresh life to Party, with financial help from Moscow

- he increased number of Unions,
- organized demonstration,
- instituted youth movements
- edited Newspapers.

1929

MEERUT CONSPIRACY CASE



Meerut conspiracy case prisoners

Activities of communist party was cut short by arrest of 32 members

Meerut case gained sympathy of nationalist.

COMMUNIST IDEOLOGY: THE RISE AND GROWTH OF THE LEFT IN INDIA

1930-1934

During the phase of CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE MOVEMENT

Communist decided to launch anti-Congress campaign and opposed policies of Nehru and Gandhi.

Described the Congress as class organization of capitalist working against interest of masses.



Learning Space

1931

KANPUR CONSPIRACY CASE

M.N. Roy was arrested

23 April, 1934

CPI called for a wide strike of all textile workers

CPI was declared illegal

COMMUNIST IDEOLOGY: THE RISE AND GROWTH OF THE LEFT IN INDIA

When communist party realized that they were isolated from political scene, they adopted a new plan, described it as "**POLICY OF INFILTRATION**" into the INC.

1937

Lucknow Agreement

Communist part of India made an **alliance with CSP (Congress socialist Party)** led by Jay Prakash Narayan.

Later, the **CPI declared an open war against congress leadership**. They wanted to free the national front from the influence of Bourgeois.

When the congress party conditionally supported British Government during second world war, **CPI strongly criticize this policy of congress**. Later **due to Russia's persuasion, CPI supported British in its war efforts**. And in turn, Indian Government lifted the ban from party.

During QIM, British used communist party as a counterpoise to the congress.

IMPORTANT FACTS RELATED TO LEFTIST MOVEMENT



M.N. ROY

- 1 In 1921, **M.N. Roy** founded “**The Communist Party of India**” at Tashkant (Soviet Union).
- 2 In September, 1924 independent of the above, **Satyabhakta Ghate** founded the **Communist Party of India** at Kanpur.
- 3 In 1925, **Labour Swaraj Party** of the Congress was founded in Bengal by Muzaffar Ahmad, Qazi Nazrul Islam and Hemank Kumar Sarkar.
- 4 In 1926, **Congress Labour Party** was founded in Bombay.

IMPORTANT FACTS RELATED TO LEFTIST MOVEMENT

- 5 In 1926, **Kirti Kisan Party of Hindustan** was founded in Madras.
- 6 In 1928, **Workers and Peasants Party** was founded.
- 7 In 1928, **Nehru with Subhash Chandra Bose** organized **Independence for India League** to fight for complete independence.
- 8 In 1940, **Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP)** was founded which was closer to CSP.
- 9 In 1939, The **Bolshevik Party of India** by N. Dutta Mazumdar.
- 10 In 1942, the **Revolutionary Communist Party of India** was founded by Soumyendranath Tagore.
- 11 In 1941, the **Bolshevik Leninist Party** was founded by Indra Sen and Ajit Roy.
- 12 In 1940, MN Roy founded another party named **Radical Democratic Party**.

COMMUNISTS

FIRST STAGE (1920 - 28)

- ✓ 1920 – **M.N.Roy**, Abani Mukherji found CPI – Tashkant
- ✓ Peshawar Conspiracy case (1922-27) → tried those who wanted to revolutionary idea
- ✓ Kanpur Conspiracy Case (1924) – Muzaffar Ahmed, S.A, Dange, Nalini Gupta
- ✓ Indian Communist Conference – 1925
- ✓ Followed unity cum struggle policy with regard to congress i.e. criticising its limitation but striving to build anti – imperialist front

SECOND STAGE (1929 – 34)

- ✓ Adopted a new ultra-leftist policy dictated by 6th comintern
- ✓ Launched an all-round **attack on Congress** leading to its isolation
- ✓ Only success of CPI was captor of leadership of AITUC
- ✓ It called for general strike, government declared CPI and other trade unions illegal.

THIRD STAGE (1934-1940)

- ✓ **Adoption of policy by Communists to infiltrate into Congress, CSP,** Forward Block and student organisation
- ✓ They gained large success but could not continue long.

FOURTH STAGE (1941-47)

- ✓ WW-II – Russia asked Indian Communists to support the British Indian Government.
- ✓ Since they agreed to it, party was **declared legal by Government**
- ✓ They **became loyal**, this brought down image of party among Indians.

FORMATION OF THE CONGRESS SOCIALIST PARTY

THE SOCIALISTS IN INDIA DID NOT PURSUE ONE COMMON IDEOLOGY



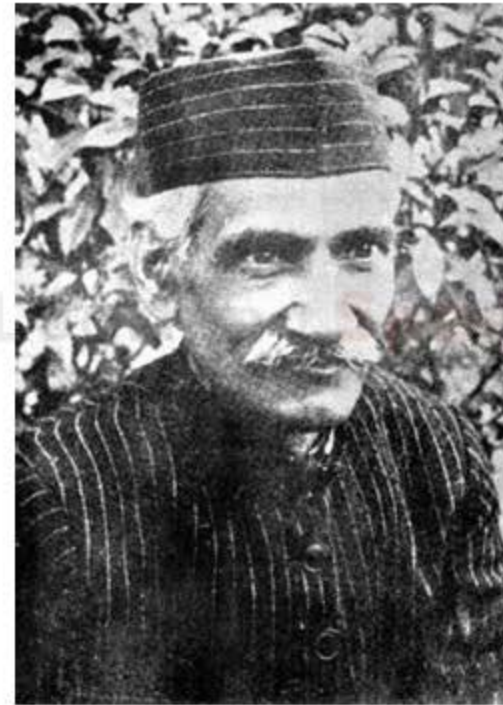
FORMATION OF THE CONGRESS SOCIALIST PARTY

ALL INDIA CONGRESS SOCIALISTS CONFERENCE

First All India Congress Socialists Conference was convened at Patna by Jai Prakash Narayana, presided by Acharya Narendra Dev in May 1934



JAI PRAKASH NARAYANA



ACHARYA NARENDRA
DEV

FORMATION OF THE CONGRESS SOCIALIST PARTY

CONGRESS SOCIALIST PARTY

The first meeting of All India Congress socialist Party was held in Bombay (Mumbai) in 1934 under the President ship of Sampurnananda.



SAMPURNANDA

3 The meeting at Bombay adopted a blue print of a 'Socialist society in India'. It adopted

Principle of Development planned by State.

Principle of Redistribution of land

Organization of the workers and the peasants

Principle Socialism of Key industries

FORMATION OF THE CONGRESS SOCIALIST PARTY

CONGRESS SOCIALIST PARTY

The Congress Socialist Party was founded by radical and young Congressmen. During the Civil Disobedience Movement they came into contact with Marxist ideas.

They were more under the influence of Western Liberalism rather than Marxian Communism.

The Congress Socialist Party wanted to change the society only gradually and by way of introducing social reforms.

- Swarajists and many other Congress leaders handled that the establishment of the party was to divide the Congress organization.
- They differed on the question of the Government of India Act 1935, the formation of ministries in 1937, the organization of Kisan Sabhas

FORMATION OF THE CONGRESS SOCIALIST PARTY

CONGRESS SOCIALIST PARTY

The Bombay Session adopted separate programme for the workers and peasants.

WORKERS DEMANDS

- Freedom to form trade unions
- The right to go on strikes,
- Living wage,
- Forty-hour week or 8 day hour movement
- Insurance against sickness, old age accident and unemployment.

PEASANTS DEMANDS

- Abolition of landlordism,
- Encouragement of cooperative farming,
- Exemption from rents and taxes on uneconomic landings
- Abolition of feudal levies.

FORMATION OF THE CONGRESS SOCIALIST PARTY

CONGRESS SOCIALIST PARTY

ASSESSMENT

Organized Peasant Movement and brought about a union among various trade unions.

It succeeded in giving radical orientation to the Congress policies.

It was due to their efforts the Indian National Congress decided to adopt socialist pattern of society after independence

Argued that Hindu-Muslim unity could be achieved not by compromise but by laying stress on economic issues.

They started mass revolutionary activities during the Quit India Movement.

SIGNIFICANT MOVEMENTS

SOCIO-REFORM MOVEMENTS

WORKING CLASS MOVEMENTS

REVOLUTIONARY MOVEMENTS

REVOLT OF 1857

PEASANTS MOVEMENTS

LEFTISTS MOVEMENTS

TRIBAL MOVEMENTS

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